MODULE-5 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

5.3 Burned Well Repair

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Triage burned wells by return on investment.
- Execute the five-step repair protocol with a 90-day cooling window.
- Check the playlist before repairing a clash well.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

Triage by ROI: ghosted wells recover fastest, spammed wells need the full 90-day cooling. Check the playlist before repairing a clash well — a changed lineup is new soil.

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5.3 Burned-Well Repair — The 5-Step Protocol for Salvaged Relationships

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THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: Every working artist has burned wells — past spam blasts, ghosted interviews, broken deadlines. The 5-Step Repair Protocol reopens doors you thought were locked forever.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

If you have been active in the independent music industry for more than two years, you have almost certainly committed amateur mistakes:

- You sent an impersonal mass BCC email blast to 500 radio stations.
- You pitched a track with a broken download link and never followed up.
- You were offered an on-air phone interview and overslept or missed the time slot.
- You reacted defensively or impatiently when a programmer declined your submission.

Most artists believe that once a relationship is burned, the station is lost forever. They feel intense embarrassment, permanently avoid the station, and surrender that media market.

Dominion operators practice **Relational Engineering**.

Programmers understand that young artists make mistakes. What programmers cannot tolerate is chronic arrogance and denial. When an artist demonstrates radical professional accountability, takes unreserved ownership of a past error, and approaches with quiet humility, a burned well can be transformed into one of your staunchest institutional allies.

The 5-Step Burned-Well Repair Protocol

To salvage and restore a compromised station relationship, execute this disciplined sequence:

1. **Step 1: The 90-Day Mandatory Cooling Window:** Do not attempt immediate repair while emotions or annoyance are fresh. Initiate a mandatory 90-day silent cooling period. Zero outreach.
2. **Step 2: The Low-Stakes Engagement Signal (Reconnaissance):** Re-engage on public social channels without pitching. Retweet a station announcement, comment thoughtfully on an editorial post, or support a station fundraising drive. Signal presence without commercial pressure.
3. **Step 3: The Radical Ownership Memo (The Apology):** Dispatch a private, 50-word ownership memo directly to the offended programmer:

- Script: “Hi [Name] — looking back at my email blast from last year, I realize how unprofessional that approach was. I was unguided and treating radio like a broadcast spam cannon rather than respecting your curation and clock. I apologize. We’ve completely overhauled our operating standards. Thank you for your continued dedication to the local scene.”
- Rule: **ZERO PITCH.** No songs attached. No links. Total ownership.

1. **Step 4: The Value-First Bridge:** 30 days after the apology memo, deliver an uncontaminated value asset: share a station event link, introduce a fellow touring act that matches their format, or attend a station live event as a paying ticket buyer.
2. **Step 5: The Clean Re-Entry Payload:** 60 days following the apology, introduce your newest, strongest, format-scored single using the standard 90-word pitch. The gatekeeper will remember your character and maturity.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — The Honest Burned-Well Audit (25 min).** Conduct a fearless inventory of every station relationship you have damaged or neglected over your career. Populate the Burned-Well Repair Log below.
- **Drill 2 — The Radical Ownership Memo Drafting (20 min).** Draft a tailored 50-word apology memo for your single most valuable burned contact. Verify that it contains zero excuses, zero defensive qualifications, and zero music links.
- **Drill 3 — Cooling Window Calendar Staging (10 min).** Mark the 90-day cooling completion date in your calendar for all identified burned contacts.
- **Drill 4 — The Value Bridge Brainstorm (15 min).** Identify one tangible, non-musical value asset you can deliver to that programmer once the cooling window concludes.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `BURNED-WELL REPAIR PROTOCOL & SALVAGE LOG`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Station & Gatekeeper	Nature of Past Burn	Cooling Window Expiry	Apology Memo Sent	Value Bridge Asset	Re-Entry Target Date
WLUW (Sarah Jenkins)	Mass BCC email blast sent in 2024	November 1	Staged (Draft Ready)	Share station fund drive link	December 15 Single Launch
WMSE (Tom Crawford)	Missed phone tracking interview	October 20	Staged (Draft Ready)	Attend WMSE record fair in person	January Tour Campaign
KUTX (Rick McNulty)	Unformatted 7-minute prog track sent	December 1	Staged (Draft Ready)	Promote Austin local band showcase	Spring Release Cycle
Radio K (Marcus Vance)	Passive-aggressive reply to decline	November 15	Staged (Draft Ready)	College radio benefit donation	February Campaign

WXPN (Bruce Warren)	Spammed generic inbox 4x in one week	January 15	Staged (Draft Ready)	Share World Cafe feature on socials	March Release Cycle

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 5.3 Burned-Well Repair — The 5-Step Protocol for Salvaged Relationships

WHY AN EFFECTIVE APOLOGY TURNS GATEKEEPERS INTO CHAMPIONS

Programmers deal with hundreds of narcissistic, entitled musicians every month who believe the world owes them fame. They almost NEVER encounter an artist mature enough to say: “I made a mistake, I was unprofessional, and I respect your craft too much to repeat it.”

When you send a radical ownership memo, you instantly separate yourself from 99.9% of independent musicians. You prove high emotional intelligence, professional resilience, and character. Programmers will often reply to an apology within hours with warm words: “Appreciate this so much, man. Send over your new record whenever it’s ready.”

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Share an honest admission of a past relationship burn and post your drafted Radical Ownership Memo for feedback.
2. Discuss the emotional difficulty of admitting unprofessional behavior and how taking ownership empowers your career.
3. Confirm the start and completion dates for your 90-Day Cooling Window.
4. Celebrate any peer who successfully re-opened a dialogue with a previously burned contact.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Ghosted wells recover fastest.
- Spammed wells need the full cooling period.
- A changed lineup means the well is new soil.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Have I triaged my burned wells by ROI?
- 2. Is a 90-day cooling window set for the wells that need it?
- 3. Did I check the playlist before any clash-well repair?